

Prayers for our World and the Church

5th April 2026

Ephesians 4:8

'When he ascended on high, he took many captives and gave gifts to his people.'

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that today we gather to celebrate the victory that Jesus won out of the apparent defeat of Good Friday. We can know for certain that the tomb is empty, and Jesus is now the Risen King.

We thank You that between His death on the Cross and His walking out of the tomb, He took many captives from the enemy who had enslaved them in sin. And we thank You that we also have been freed from our captivity to sin so that we may live according to Your free gift of righteousness.

We thank You that because Jesus rose, we have been forgiven by Your grace and mercy alone. We thank You that we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, commemorating the Cross and the Resurrection.

We thank You for sending the Holy Spirit, Third Person of the Trinity, to be with us daily, to come alongside and enable us to resist temptation, to open our minds to Your Word, and to grant us wisdom as we live in this fallen world.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We pray for this world which continues blindly on its unrepentant way, ignoring the Rising of the Prince of Peace, Who is now Ascended and reigning from heaven. We pray for many eyes to be opened to Your general Providence, and to Your saving love, both at this season and every day.

We thank You for the many churches where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, and ask that You would strengthen Your people to stand firm but with grace, against the lies so popular today.

We pray for those close to us, who do not know the Truth. Grant us wisdom to know when and how to share the Good News that Jesus lives.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, as we also labour with our various talents and abilities in the work of the Kingdom.

We know that in this fallen world, our outer man grows weaker every day, yet we continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Alan, Diane, Russell and others affected by illness or injury. We remember Levi, and ask that You continue to strengthen him in his development day by day. We pray that You would continue to strengthen us so that we can witness to the truth of the Risen Lord, and the sure hope of eternal life in Him.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Chris as he preaches today. We pray that we would be diligent receivers of the means of grace, both in Your Word and in the sacrament.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.

As we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, let us recall the fundamentals of our faith by reciting The Apostle's Creed:

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit
and born of the virgin Mary.
He suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried;
he descended to hell.
The third day he rose again from the dead.
He ascended to heaven
and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty.
From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic* church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting. Amen.

Our Father, Who is in heaven,
hallowed be Your name;
Your kingdom come;
Your will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.

Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those that trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation;
but deliver us from evil.

For Yours is the kingdom,
the power, and the glory,
for ever and ever.

Amen.

They shall not grow old, as we that are left grow old.

Age shall not weary them, nor the years condemn.

At the going down of the sun, and in the morning,

We WILL remember them.

Lest We Forget